

STAGE EIGHT • SOFT SKILLS

FIRSTS

DISCUSSION PROMPTS

Open-ended questions to seed group conversation beyond the worksheets

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Discussion Prompts

Stage Eight • Soft Skills

PURPOSE

Individual worksheets answer “what did you write for this reflection?” These prompts answer a different question: “what's your real, lived experience with this soft skill?” They're open-ended and personal, meant to seed conversation beyond a simple share-out of worksheet answers.

Given how emotionally and interpersonally involved this stage already is, these prompts work especially well as closing questions for a session, giving the room a chance to connect individual reflection to shared, relatable experience before moving on.

They're organized by session (matching this stage's six sections), four prompts each. As always, pick the one or two that feel most alive for the room rather than working through all four every time.

Prompts by Session

SESSION 1

Communication & Listening

"Have you ever realized mid-conversation that you weren't actually listening, just waiting for your turn to talk? What snapped you out of it?"

"What's a communication style you've had to consciously adjust for a specific person or situation?"

"Has someone's body language ever told you something their words didn't?"

"What's the hardest part about staying quiet when you have something you're excited to add?"

SESSION 2

Emotional Intelligence & Self-Awareness

"What's an emotional pattern of yours that took you a long time to actually notice?"

"Has genuinely trying to see someone else's side ever changed your mind about a real disagreement?"

"What's a moment you regulated a strong emotion well under real pressure? What did you actually do?"

"How has your understanding of a value you hold changed since you first tried to write it down?"

SESSION 3

Feedback & Conflict Resolution

"What's the best piece of feedback you've ever received, and what made it land well?"

"Have you ever avoided a conflict that later got worse because you avoided it? What would you do differently now?"

"What's it like to genuinely mediate between two people, versus just picking a side quietly?"

"What's a boundary you're still working up the courage to set?"

SESSION 4

Teamwork & Collaboration

"What's the most genuinely difficult team collaboration you've been part of, and what did you learn from it?"

"What team role do you default to, and what would it take to try a genuinely different one?"

"Has a group decision you were part of ever unraveled later because buy-in wasn't actually real?"

"Who's a teammate whose contribution you've noticed but never actually told them about?"

SESSION 5

Networking & Public Speaking

"What's a networking conversation that felt genuinely good, not transactional? What made it different?"

"What's your real relationship with public speaking — has it changed over time, and what changed it?"

"What's the best question you've ever gotten asked during a Q&A, and how did you handle it?"

"Who's a mentor or peer you've learned the most from, and what made that relationship actually work?"

SESSION 6

Growth Mindset & Resilience

"What's a moment of unexpected change that, looking back, you handled better than you expected to?"

"Has a first impression you had about someone ever turned out to be genuinely wrong?"

"What's a real setback you're still working through, even in a small way?"

"Looking at this entire stage, what soft skill do you feel has genuinely grown the most, and how do you know?"